world. Hence, for an American, the image of the Soviet Government during the Cold War days was that of a deceitful, untrustworthy, aggressive, unreliable nation which represented an evil empire and must be “contained”.

However, it would be too pessimistic to totally negate the importance of world public opinion. World public opinion was supposed to be the foundation of the League of Nations (1919) which was to be the enforcement agency for the Kellog–Briand Pact of 1928, the decisions of the Permanent Court of International Justice and international law in general. Under the present situation, because of globalization and immense revolution in technological front and information technology (IT), common problems relating to peace, war, environment, development, sustainable development, disarmament, equity and justice, democracy and other issues have induced individuals to transcend national barriers and establish a psychological unity among peoples of different states and thus pave the way for the development of world public opinion. It must also be acknowledged that world public opinion does have a restraining effect on the actions of the states. Even the sole surviving superpower, viz. USA, cannot disregard the world public opinion and hence it is often engaged in the task of justifying its action as one upholding international law, international morality and world public opinion. Most governments are very much concerned with their prestige and cannot afford the world to be critical of its policy abroad. It is only under certain crisis situations that the states are bent on defending their objectives even at the risk of breaking commitments, violating norms while strictly following national imperatives. But under normal conditions, the statesmen and diplomats choose policy alternatives which are likely to meet less hostile reaction and evoke world public opinion.